

The Barbados Moving Checklist

29 steps, in order, from six months before your move to your first three months on the island.

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 Work through the stages in order.
Each stage starts things the next one depends on.
- 2 Tick each step and note the date.
Use the space on the right of every step.
- 3 Check official sources before you act.
Fees and rules change. Official links are on the last page.

NUMBERS TO KNOW

511	211	311	BBD \$3.50	2:1
AMBULANCE	POLICE	FIRE	BUS FARE	BBD TO USD

Main public hospital: Queen Elizabeth Hospital, Martindale's Road, St. Michael. Accident & Emergency: 246-436-6450.

YOUR MOVE

Moving date	
Visa or residency route	
Parishes shortlisted	
Shipping company	
Temporary address	

Six months before

Decide the big things and start anything with a long lead time.

- | | | |
|--------------------------|---|------------------|
| ☐ | Choose your visa or residency route
Compare the Welcome Stamp, SERP and work permit routes. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Set a realistic monthly budget
Use the cost of living calculator on the site. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Shortlist two or three parishes
Take the parish quiz and read the parish guides. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Check passports are valid
Allow plenty of time before expiry. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Contact shortlisted schools
Ask about places, fees, deadlines and document rules. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Start the pet import process
Microchip, rabies vaccine and any blood test can take months. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Get quotes from shipping companies
Compare at least three. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Ask your bank for a reference letter
Local banks usually want one. | Done ____ / ____ |
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NOTES FOR THIS STAGE

One month before

Confirm paperwork and prepare to leave.

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- | | | |
|--------------------------|--|------------------|
| ☐ | Submit or confirm your visa application
Keep copies of everything. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Arrange health insurance to start on arrival
Check evacuation cover and what's covered locally. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Book temporary accommodation
Somewhere to stay while you view rentals in person. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Gather key documents in one folder
Birth, marriage, school and medical records, driving licence. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Get a letter from your doctor and refill prescriptions
Bring enough for your first weeks, in original packaging. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Notify banks, pension and tax authorities at home
Update your address and residency. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Cancel or transfer home utilities and subscriptions
Avoid paying for services you won't use. | Done ____ / ____ |
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NOTES FOR THIS STAGE

First week

Get connected and find your bearings.

- ☐ **Get a local SIM** Done ____ / ____
Prepaid is quickest. Bring your passport.
- ☐ **Save emergency numbers** Done ____ / ____
Ambulance 511, Police 211, Fire 311.
- ☐ **Learn your bus routes or arrange a car** Done ____ / ____
Flat BBD \$3.50 fare. Barbados drives on the left.
- ☐ **Book a bank account appointment** Done ____ / ____
Bring two photo IDs, proof of address and your reference letter.
- ☐ **View rentals in your shortlisted parishes** Done ____ / ____
Visit at different times of day.
- ☐ **Find your nearest pharmacy and a private GP** Done ____ / ____
Before you need them.
- ☐ **Stock up on essentials** Done ____ / ____
Compare supermarkets and local markets.

NOTES FOR THIS STAGE

First three months

Settle in for the long term.

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- | | | |
|--------------------------|---|------------------|
| ☐ | Sign a longer-term lease
Check who pays which utility bills. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Set up electricity, water and internet
Get the tenant advice form from your landlord first. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Get your Trident ID, then your local driving licence
Licensing Authority, The Pine, St. Michael. Cash only. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Register children at school
Bring all enrolment documents. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Join a community group or club
The fastest way to meet people. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Review your budget against real spending
Adjust now rather than later. | Done ____ / ____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Put visa renewal dates in your calendar
Leave time for paperwork. | Done ____ / ____ |
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NOTES FOR THIS STAGE

Official sources

Confirm fees and rules here before you act.

Welcome Stamp	barbadoswelcomestamp.bb
Immigration Department (SERP and work permits)	immigration.gov.bb
Returning nationals: Barbados Network Programme	foreign.gov.bb/barbados-network-programme
Ministry of Health and Wellness	health.gov.bb
Ministry of Education	education.gov.bb
Barbados Light & Power	blpc.com.bb
Barbados Water Authority	barbadoswaterauthority.com

Notes

Last verified: September 2026. This checklist is general guidance, not legal, immigration or financial advice. Always confirm with the official source before you act. The full guide, including visas, cost of living, parishes, healthcare and schools, is on the Moving to Barbados website.